# LEVOCETIRIZINE

Once daily
Evening dose

**CHEMICAL NAME** (R)-2-[2-[4-[(4-chlorophenyl)(phenyl)methyl]piperazin-1-yl]ethoxy]acetic acid (dihydrochloride)

**CLASS** Second-generation H1 antihistamine (R-enantiomer of cetirizine)

**TRADE NAMES** Xyzal · Xozal · Levazyr

## THERAPEUTIC USES / INDICATIONS

- Allergic rhinitis (seasonal, perennial).
- Chronic idiopathic urticaria.

## PHARMACODYNAMICS

- Potent selective peripheral **H1 antagonist** (twice the affinity of cetirizine).

## ADMINISTRATION

- **PO** once daily in the evening, with or without food.

## SIDE & ADVERSE EFFECTS

### SIDE EFFECTS (COMMON)

- Somnolence, fatigue.
- Dry mouth, headache.
- Pharyngitis.

### ADVERSE EFFECTS (SERIOUS)

- Urinary retention.
- Hypersensitivity.
- Seizures (rare).

## DOSAGES

- **Adult & ≥12 yr:** 5 mg once daily.
- **6–11 yr:** 2.5 mg once daily.
- **2–5 yr:** 1.25 mg twice daily (oral solution).
- Renal impairment: reduce (CrCl 30–49: 5 mg every 2 days; <30: every 3 days).

## CONTRAINDICATIONS & CAUTIONS

- End-stage renal disease (CrCl <10); haemodialysis.
- Children <6 months.
- Hypersensitivity to piperazines.

### KEY INTERACTIONS

- **Alcohol, CNS depressants:** ↑ sedation.

## PHARMACOKINETICS

- **Onset:** 1 h. **Duration:** 24 h.
- Minimal metabolism.
- Excreted unchanged in urine. **t½:** 8 h.

## NURSING MANAGEMENT

- Check renal function.
- Assess symptom relief.
- Advise about drowsiness.

## PATIENT EDUCATION

- Take in the evening.
- Avoid alcohol; check how it affects you before driving.

**KEY POINTS**

- Active enantiomer of cetirizine.
- Renally excreted.
- 5 mg once daily (evening).
- Mild sedation.

**SOURCES CHECKED** **[488]** Levocetirizine 5 mg film-coated tablets (UK SmPC) **[489]** levocetirizine dihydrochloride, oral (US label) **[490]** levocetirizine dihydrochloride, oral (US label, Padagis Israel Pharmaceuticals Ltd)

*Full references p. 432–457*